

Preston Chen

Frontend Design Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Frontend Design Engineer with 8+ years of experience bridging design and development. Combines a BA in Graphic Design with deep technical expertise in React, TypeScript, and modern animation libraries. Specializes in building design systems, component libraries, and creating pixel-perfect, performant user interfaces with thoughtful microinteractions. Proven track record of collaborating with design teams to translate Figma mockups into production-ready, accessible components.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Sketch, Prototyping Tools, Design Systems

Frontend Engineering: React.js, TypeScript, Next.js, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, SASS

Animation & Graphics: Framer Motion, Three.js, React Three Fiber, GSAP, WebGL, P5.js

Design Systems: Component Architecture, Design Tokens, Storybook, Accessibility (WCAG)

Backend & Tools: Node.js, GraphQL, REST APIs, Git, GitHub, Docker, Kubernetes

Databases: MongoDB, SQL

Additional: Python, Django, Data Visualization, Performance Optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer III | Synapsefi | San Francisco, CA

July 2019 - October 2023

- Architected and maintained React.js component library following design system principles, ensuring consistent UI/UX across multiple banking products
- Designed and implemented client settings dashboard module with intuitive UI for managing user permissions and financial account limits
- Collaborated with design team to create pixel-perfect implementations of complex financial interfaces
- Contributed to core API microservices while maintaining design-development workflow efficiency
- Built interactive data visualization components for bank statements and financial reports, processing 10k+ account migrations
- Optimized component performance for large batch operations and real-time cryptocurrency liquidation reporting

Contract Frontend Design Engineer | Multiple Companies | San Francisco, CA

Lion Interactive, BriteLite Immersive, ViewFind, BrightEdge | March 2015 - July 2019

- Designed and developed interactive multimedia web experiences utilizing React.js, sound design, animations, images, and video for immersive editorial content
- Contributed to UI component design systems, establishing reusable patterns and design tokens for scalability
- Collaborated closely with design and backend teams through iterative design-development cycles to deliver products aligned with client expectations
- Translated Figma/Sketch designs into responsive, accessible React components integrated with Django admin and REST APIs
- Created motion design specifications and implemented smooth microinteractions using CSS animations and JavaScript
- Established component API standards and documentation for design handoff processes

EDUCATION

University of Boulder — MS Data Science | 2023 - Present

San Jose State University — BA Graphic Design | Graduated

FEATURED PROJECTS & DESIGN WORK

Design System & Component Library | Synapsefi

- Built comprehensive React component library with variants, states, and accessibility features
- Established design token system for colors, typography, spacing, and elevation
- Created Storybook documentation for 50+ reusable components

Autonomous Vehicle Data Visualization | Personal Project

- Designed and developed real-time ROS (Robot Operating System) data visualization dashboard for self-driving car telemetry
- Built interactive 3D vehicle positioning and sensor data display using React Three Fiber and WebGL
- Implemented WebSocket integration for live streaming of autonomous vehicle metrics and camera feeds
- Created responsive data visualization components for LIDAR point clouds, trajectory planning, and obstacle detection
- Tech stack: React.js, TypeScript, ROS Bridge, Three.js, D3.js, WebSockets

Multimedia Editorial Experiences | BriteLite Immersive

- Designed and developed immersive web experiences combining sound design, video, and interactive animations
- Implemented responsive layouts optimized for multi-device storytelling

- Focused on performance optimization for media-heavy applications

PROFESSIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

- Unique hybrid background: Formal design education (BA Graphic Design) + extensive engineering experience
- Design + Code specialist: Can design in Figma AND implement production-ready components
- Design systems advocate: Strong believer in component-driven development and systematic design thinking
- Bridge builder: Experience facilitating communication between design and engineering teams
- Performance focused: Passionate about creating delightful user experiences through thoughtful microinteractions and optimization